

Testimonial from Atlantic Centre**African Excellence Awards 2026**

To the African Excellence Awards 2026 Committee, we hereby write this testimonial for the Gulf of Guinea Maritime Institute, a partner institution of the Atlantic Centre since 2023.

The Atlantic Centre is a Portuguese initiative that brings together a multinational and multidisciplinary platform which, by adopting a broad concept of security and a “Whole of the Atlantic” approach, seeks to promote political dialogue, the dissemination and production of knowledge and doctrine, and capacity-building in security and defence within an Atlantic Community of Interest. Launched in May 2021 by a group of 16 countries that signed a political declaration it has since grown to include 28 signatory states across West Africa, Europe, and North and South America, while also collaborating with a range of international think tanks and organizations including the Gulf of Guinea Maritime Institute (GoGMI).

The Atlantic Centre is proud of our partnership with GoGMI. Since our foundation that we have been trailing a path towards increased cooperation, knowledge sharing and mutual growth between both institutions. We are proud to attest, as partners, the recent development of GoGMI. Since its establishment, GoGMI has been a pivotal institution in the Gulf of Guinea, researching and training civil society, governments and military on grey zone topics within the overarching area of Maritime Security.

What distinguishes GoGMI apart is not only the quality of its training and research, but also its commitment to inclusive, African-led solutions. By bringing together stakeholders from across governments, armed forces, academia, and civil society, the Institute has contributed meaningfully to building trust, enhancing coordination, and advancing sustainable maritime governance. Which is no small achievement, considering recent developments within the geopolitical context of the Atlantic basin.

The Atlantic Centre has been able to engage with GoGMI on several areas of mutual interest. We have signed a Memorandum of Understanding in 2023, and since then we

have developed joint research, conferences and courses particularly in advancing maritime security and cooperative frameworks across the Atlantic space with a particular focus on the Gulf of Guinea region.

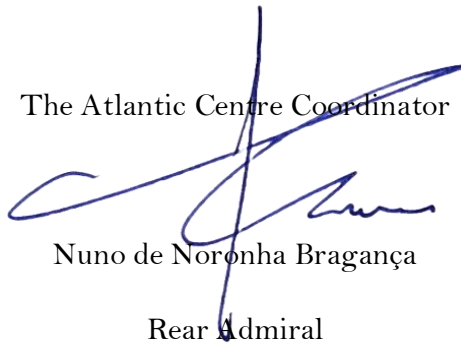
We believe, considering our reach and work within the Atlantic Basin, that GoGMI is arising to one of the key African-led Think Tanks in the broad geography of the Gulf of Guinea. In a context where maritime insecurity, illegal activities, and environmental pressures continue to pose serious challenges, institutions like GoGMI are indispensable.

For these reasons, the Atlantic Centre fully supports GoGMI's nomination for the African Excellence Awards 2026. We are confident that its achievements and impact make it a most deserving candidate for this recognition.

We remain at your disposal should you require any further information.

Very Respectfully,

The Atlantic Centre Coordinator

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to be "Nuno de Noronha Bragança", written over the printed name and title.

Nuno de Noronha Bragança

Rear Admiral